

Dongdong Zhu

CONTACT INFORMATION

One Shields Avenue, Davis, CA 95616, USA

zddzhu@ucdavis.edu
Personal Website | Google Scholar

EDUCATION

University of California, Davis
PhD Student, Department of Communication
Supervised by [Soojong Kim](#)

Davis, CA, USA
Sept. 2025 - June 2030 (Expected)

University of Amsterdam
Research Master in Communication Science
Supervised by [Anne Kroon](#)

Amsterdam, Netherlands
Sept. 2023 - June 2025

London School of Economics and Political Science
MSc in Media and Communications

London, UK
Sept. 2018 - Nov. 2019

Renmin University of China
BA in Journalism

Beijing, China
Sept. 2014 - June 2018

PUBLICATIONS

Kim, S., Kim, H., Kim, K., & **Zhu, D.** (2026). Algorithmic Portrayals of Mental Health Stigma: Quantifying the Gap Between AI Estimations and Human Perceptions Across Gender Groups. *Social Science & Medicine*. [\[DOI\]](#)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Kim, H., Kim, S., **Zhu, D.**, & Lam, H. (2026). When can multimodal AI support content analysis? Evidence from mental health stories on YouTube. *Accepted for presentation at the 60th Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences*, Honolulu, HI, USA.

Kim, S., Kim, H., Kim, K., & **Zhu, D.** (2026). Algorithmic portrayals of mental health stigma: Quantifying the gap between AI estimations and human perceptions across gender groups. *Presented at the 109th Annual Conference of the Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC)*, New Orleans, LA, USA. Top Faculty Conference Paper Award, Communication Science, Health, Environment and Risk Division.

Zhu, D. (2026). A Mirror of Reality? Visual Representations of Female Politicians in the EU Across Search Engines and Generative AI. *Presented at the 76th Annual Conference of International Communication Association (ICA)*, Cape Town, South Africa.

Kim, K., Kim, S., Niederdeppe, J., Byrne, S., & **Zhu, D.** (2026). Bias in Multimodal Generative AI Evaluations of Vaping Risk Perceptions and Willingness: Comparison with Human Reference Data from a Vaping Warning Message Effect Experiment. *Presented at the 76th Annual Conference of International Communication Association (ICA)*, Cape Town, South Africa.

Zhu, D. (2026). Whose Morality? Uncovering Ideological Asymmetries in How Large Language Models Judge Political Arguments. *Presented at the CSS Escape 2026*, Davis, USA.

Zhu, D., Khanna, S., Ausloos, J., & Leerssen, P. (2026). Banned from Detecting Shadowbans. *Presented at the Etmaal van de Communicatiewetenschap*, Arnhem, Netherlands.

Wirz, D., Schneider, F., Schäfer, S., **Zhu, D.,** & Tan, Y. (2025). TikTok News and (the Illusion of) Knowledge: An Experiment Combining Self-reports and Physiological Measurements. *Presented at the 75th Annual Conference of International Communication Association (ICA)*, Denver, USA.

Zhu, D. (2024). Are housewives getting depressed? A machine learning study based on YouTube. *Presented at the 74th Annual Conference of International Communication Association (ICA) Regional Hub*, Beijing, China.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	University of Amsterdam	Amsterdam, Netherlands
	<i>Research Assistant, the Invisible Lab</i>	May - Aug. 2025
	Supervised by Saurabh Khanna	
	<i>Research Assistant, Digital Communication Methods Lab</i>	May - Dec. 2024
	Supervised by Joanna Strycharz	
	<i>Research Assistant, ASCoR</i>	Mar. - Dec. 2024
	Supervised by Dominique Wirz, Svenja Schäfer, Frank Schneider	
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	University of California, Davis	Davis, CA, USA
	<i>Teaching Assistant, Department of Communication</i>	
	CMN 001: Introduction to Public Speaking	Fall 2025 – Summer 2026
	CMN 161: Health Communication	Fall 2026
	CMN 165: Media & Health	Fall 2026
ACADEMIC SERVICE	Common Horizons 2026	Davis, CA, USA
	<i>Panel Chair, "Governance, Extremism, and Regulatory Questions"</i>	2026
	76th Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA) Cape Town, South Africa	
	<i>Reviewer</i>	2026
PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	Xiaomi Inc.	Beijing, China
	<i>Marketing Specialist, Global Marketing Department</i>	Mar. 2020 - Feb. 2023
	Tencent Inc.	Remote
	<i>Freelancer, Platform and Content Group</i>	Nov. 2017 - Mar. 2020
GRANTS	Small Grant, Department of Communication	2026
	<i>University of California, Davis (\$1,000)</i>	
	Thesis Grant, Digital Communication Methods Lab	2025
	<i>University of Amsterdam (€500)</i>	
HONORS & AWARDS	Top Faculty Conference Paper Award	2026
	<i>Communication Science, Health, Environment and Risk Division, AEJMC</i>	

Awarded to “Algorithmic portrayals of mental health stigma” (with S. Kim, H. Kim, and K. Kim).

National Encouragement Scholarship 2017, 2015
Renmin University of China (¥5,000)

Outstanding Student Leader Award 2017, 2016
Renmin University of China

Second Prize, Undergraduate Research Foundation 2017
Renmin University of China

Excellent Works Prize, AD Campus Spring Competition 2017
AD Campus (National Level)

Third Prize Scholarship 2016
Renmin University of China (¥1,000)

SKILLS

Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent, IELTS: 8.0)

Programming: Python, R (Data Cleaning, Visualization, Machine Learning)

Tools: L^AT_EX, SPSS, Gephi (Network Analysis), Adobe Photoshop, Premiere Pro